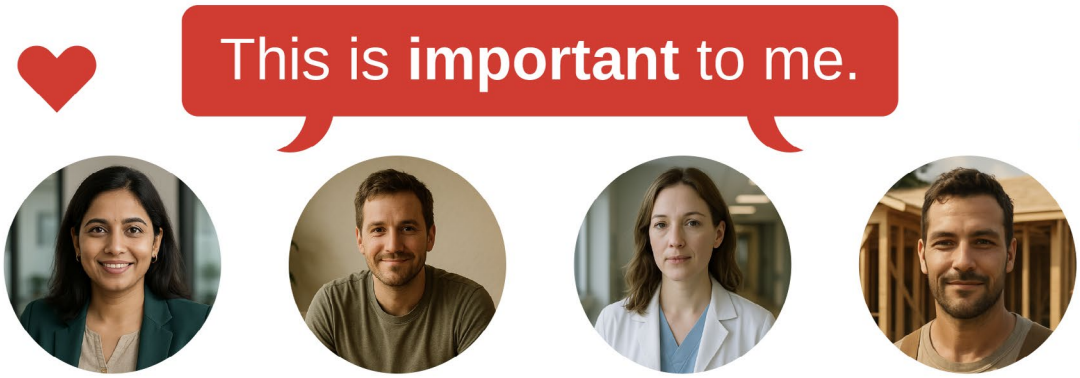

Fast-Track the Features Your Users Will Love

Persona-Weighted Feature Matrix

This simple tool helps you see which features actually matter to your users. It makes tough design calls feel obvious, keeps your work focused on real user needs, and shows everyone that you don't guess; your decisions are grounded in empathy and evidence.

Use it whenever new features start piling up and your team can't agree on priorities. This template will stop you from arguing about features and help you start designing for real people.

How To Use This Template

Use the guide below with the included spreadsheet template once you've defined your features, epics, and constraints, but before you move into modeling or prototyping. You'll get the best outcomes if you use it collaboratively with your team and include UX designers, product managers, and developers. This way, everyone has a shared view of what matters and why.

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Persona-Weighted Feature Matrix: The Step-by-Step Guide

Step 1: Set Up Your Matrix

1. Open the **spreadsheet** that came with this PDF. It's an **.xlsx file**, so you can open it in almost any spreadsheet application, including Microsoft Excel, Apple Numbers, or in a browser using Google Sheets.

2. Label the **columns** with your personas.

- Include both **primary** and **secondary** personas.
- **Secondary personas** often share needs with primaries but have unique variations.

3. Next to each persona's name, assign a **numerical persona weight** that reflects how important that persona is to your project.

- These weights are arbitrary, but it helps if they add up to 100 for easy comparison.
- For example: Primary Persona 1 = 45, Primary Persona 2 = 35, Secondary Persona = 20.

Step 2: List Your Features

1. Use the **rows** to list the **features** or **stories of use** you are considering.

- A "story of use" could be a use case, user story, or persona story: any clear description of what a user wants to do. You can use these in place of features if it makes more sense for your project.

2. Each row represents one feature or story.

Step 3: Weigh Each Feature for Each Persona

1. For every cell where a feature (row) meets a persona (column), assign a **feature weight** showing how much that persona values or is affected by the feature.

2. You can use the following scale (or adapt it to suit your needs):

- **2** Persona loves or must have this feature
- **1** Persona likes or benefits from this feature
- **0** Feature neither helps nor harms this persona
- **-1** Feature harms or frustrates this persona

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Step 4: Calculate Each Feature for Each Persona

These calculations are built into the spreadsheet, but here's how to do them manually:

1. Multiply each persona's weight by their feature weight.

> **Example:** *If Persona A has a weight of 45 and gives a feature a 2, that's 90 points from Persona A.*

2. Add up all these weighted scores across the personas for that feature.

3. The total score shows the **overall importance of that feature** to your combined user base.

Step 5: Analyze Your Results

- Features with the highest total scores are the most important to your personas overall.
- Review any features with negative scores. You may need to redesign, re-evaluate, or remove them.
- Discuss results with your team to confirm that your prioritization aligns with business goals and development constraints.

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Example

The table below shows an example of how to calculate and compare feature scores in your persona-weighted feature matrix.

Feature	Feature Name	Persona: Alex (Weight 50)	Persona: Jordan (Weight 25)	Persona: Sam (Weight 15)	Persona: Taylor (Weight 10)	Total: 100
1	One-Click Login	2	1	0	-1	**Score: 115**
2	Personalized Dashboard	2	2	1	0	**Score: 165**

How to Read the Table

1. Weights (top row): These show how important each persona is to your project.

- In this example, Alex carries the most weight (50), and Taylor the least (10).

2. Feature weights (middle rows): These are the ratings (2, 1, 0, –1) that reflect how much each persona values or dislikes each feature.

3. Scores (final column):

- Multiply each persona's weight by their rating, then sum across all personas.

Example: ***One-click login*** $= (2\times50) + (1\times25) + (0\times15) + (-1\times10) = \mathbf{115}$

Personalized dashboard $= (2\times50) + (2\times25) + (1\times15) + (0\times10) = \mathbf{165}$

4. Interpretation:

- Features with higher total scores are more valuable overall.
- Here, "Personalized dashboard" (165) ranks higher than "One-click login" (115), so it should take priority.

You can find a full example of a filled-in persona-weighted feature matrix in the included spreadsheet. There are both sorted and unsorted examples.

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- **Craft your personal portfolio** with results that prove your value. You'll create career assets like conceptual models and design maps that show how you can move from requirements to **implementation-ready UIs that users love.**

Learn more about this course >

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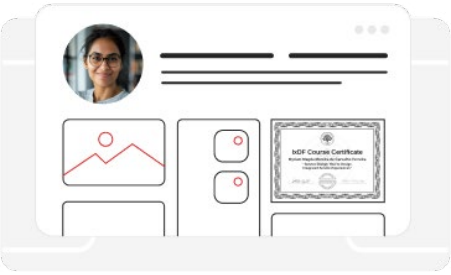

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